

1. State of AI Agents

“2025 is the year of AI agents”, claimed OpenAI Chief Product Officer Kevin Weil during this year’s World Economic Forum in Davos ([Axios, 2025](#)). With similar pomp, Salesforce CEO Marc Benioff announced in September 2024 that the goal of his company was to “empower one billion agents [...] by the end of 2025” ([Salesforce, 2024](#)). Predictions highlighting agents’ transformative effects in the near future were made by most major tech CEOs, including Sam Altman ([2025](#)) and Mark Zuckerberg ([ZDNET, 2025](#)).

Agents are AI applications that can execute complex tasks on their own, both in virtual and real-world settings. As of now, agents remain focused on specific tasks like managing inboxes and booking flights. But if they live up to their promise, they may soon become highly-capable digital coworkers or personal assistants. As such, the autonomy of agents, and their capacity to take direct action mark a fundamental shift, moving AI “through the chat window and into the real world” ([CSET, 2025](#)). While agents’ precise impact is yet to be seen, one thing is clear: major technology companies are making a concerted effort to turn their predictions into reality, investing large sums and releasing an ever-growing array of AI agent products and features.